BTC 8-Hour Market Report

BTC ~ $81,500

Sunday 18 Oct 2026, 23:50 Malaysia time (15:50 UTC)

Seen $81.0k-81.9k today (CoinDesk, Cryptonews); 24h ~flat; week -1.3%

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, slight downside risk into the US open	**Next 24h range:** $80,300 - $82,800 (base case)	**Key floor:** $79,700-80,000 (week low), then $78,000	**Big event:** US stocks reopen Mon 9:30pm MYT (Black Monday anniversary); $12.2B monthly expiry 30 Oct

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

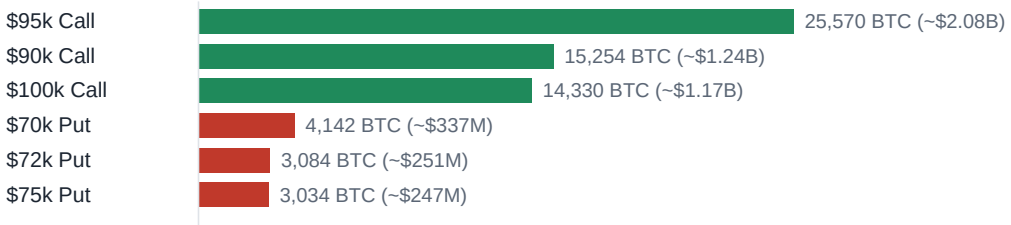
- **Next expiry:** Deribit daily, Monday 19 Oct, 4:00pm MYT (08:00 UTC). No published size found; daily expiries are normally small next to the weeklies, so this one is unlikely to move price by itself.
- **Next weekly:** Friday 23 Oct, 4:00pm MYT - about 14,759 BTC (~$1.2B at $81.5k), similar in size to last Friday's $1.47B expiry.
- **The expiry that matters:** the 30 Oct monthly - $12.2B (149,686 BTC), about ten times the weekly, put/call 0.52 and max pain $79,000. Its strikes shape the market all week.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
19 Oct daily	Not published	n/a	Too small to report; little pinning effect expected
23 Oct weekly	Total 14,759 BTC	~$1.2B	Strike split not yet published; moderate pull into Friday
30 Oct monthly - call	$95,000 call	25,570 BTC (~$2.08B)	Biggest upside bet, far above price (+17%) - a ceiling magnet only in a rally
30 Oct monthly - put	$70,000 put	4,142 BTC (~$337M)	Biggest downside hedge; tail protection, not near-term

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Mon 19 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	n/a	n/a	n/a	Not published
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.2B (14,759 BTC)	n/a	n/a	Not published yet
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	$12.2B (149,686 BTC)	0.52	$79,000	Calls $95k 25,570 / $90k 15,254 / $100k 14,330; Puts $70k 4,142 / $72k 3,084 / $75k 3,034 BTC
Fri 16 Oct (expired, for reference)	$1.47B (18,029 BTC)	1.37	$83,000	Puts $78k 2,746 / $80k 2,142; Calls $90k 1,144

30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (Deribit, BTC)



How options affect the market now

- **Max pain sits below price:** the monthly max pain of $79,000 is ~3% under spot. Into 30 Oct there is a mild pull lower, and $79k-80k is where option sellers do best.
- **Call-heavy but far away:** P/C 0.52 shows bullish positioning, but the big call walls ($90k, $95k, $100k) are 10-23% above price. They matter only if BTC first rallies through $84k-87k; then dealer hedging could speed the move.
- **Thin put walls nearby:** the largest puts are at $70k-75k, so there is no heavy option floor just under $80k. A break of $79.7k could run further before hedging flows slow it.

- **Last week's sentiment flip:** the 16 Oct weekly was put-heavy (P/C 1.37, puts at $78k-80k). Those hedges are gone, which removes some support in the $78k-80k zone.
- **Volatility is cheap:** last published DVOL was ~37.7 (12 Oct), about 2.0% per day (~$1,600). Options are not pricing a big shock, so a sharp US-session move could catch sellers short volatility.
- **Next 24h expiry:** too small to matter; the weekly on Friday and the monthly on 30 Oct are the real drivers.

Data note: the Deribit live API could not be reached this run, so open interest comes from CryptoTicker (17 Oct) and other published reports. Sizes are 'largest seen' and USD values use ~$81,400. DVOL is the latest published figure (12 Oct), not a live read.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC is ~$81,000-81,900 late Sunday; CoinDesk showed $81,909 (+0.6% 24h) at 9:07pm MYT, and Cryptonews $81,021 (-0.45%) a little later.
- Week range $79,676-84,262 (Coinbase): high Monday, low Thursday after the hot US CPI, close down 1.3% on the week.
- Weekend shakeout on 17-18 Oct: a quick ~$1,000 drop and ~$1,200 rebound, with $51.6M liquidated in 10 minutes (CoinGlass via Analytics Insight).
- Price sits just under the 50-, 100- and 200-day averages; daily signals lean sell, weekly still constructive (NordFX). Volume on the bounce is light.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,300 / $86,000-87,100	Week high and rejection zone; $87.2k is the 2 Oct high and near the 20-month average
Resistance 1	$82,500-83,000	Intraday sellers; $83k was last week's max pain
Pivot	$81,000-81,700	Current balance area of the weekend range
Support 1	$79,700-80,000	Week low ($79,676) and round number; just above monthly max pain $79k
Support 2	$77,500-78,000	Glassnode loss-selling bottom zone
Deep risk	$75,000 / $70,000-72,000	Largest monthly put strikes; NordFX sees mid-$70ks if $79.8k breaks

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	$7.68B (-0.69% 24h, sample); $65.2B all perps	Leverage easing slightly, not flushed
Funding (8h)	+0.0035% to +0.01%	Near neutral; longs pay a little
Long/short accounts	63.2% long	Crowd leans long - fuel if support breaks
Liquidations	$315M 24h (Sat, 66% longs); ~$1B on 15 Oct	Big long flush already happened midweek
Spot BTC ETF flows	16 Oct -$82.4M; 12-16 Oct -$228M; Oct MTD -$615M	Steady outflows - no institutional bid
Fear & Greed	40 (Fear, 17 Oct, Au79); CMC 48-49 Neutral	Cautious, not panicked
Implied vol (DVOL)	~37.7 (last published 12 Oct)	~2.0% daily move priced; low vs history

4. News and macro

- **Hot US inflation:** September CPI +0.6% m/m (3.7% y/y) and PPI +1.3% m/m; 10-year yield ~5.09-5.10%. Fed hike odds for 28 Oct vary widely by source (about 13% per CME/Polymarket on 16 Oct vs ~52% in NordFX's read).

- **Oil shock:** Brent ~$110 (+4.7% week) on Iranian attacks on Strait of Hormuz shipping; risk assets under pressure, Kospi -7.6% Thursday, Nasdaq -2.1% Friday.
- **Black Monday fears:** weekend selloff in crypto and AI-stock perps ahead of the US reopen on 19 Oct (Black Monday anniversary).
- **Treasury firms:** MSCI will exclude non-operating firms from its indexes (Strategy -9.6%); Strategy still bought 250 BTC (848,250 total); Strive bought ~6,100 BTC.
- **Adoption:** Charles Schwab opened BTC/ETH trading to all eligible clients; Sberbank approved to run a crypto exchange from 1 Dec.
- **Security/tech:** Google Willow quantum progress revived talk of risk to old exposed BTC keys; no major exchange hack reported.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Mon 19 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily options expiry
Mon 19 Oct, 9:30pm / 10:00pm	US stocks open (Black Monday anniversary); NAHB housing index
Tue 20 Oct, 8:30pm / 10:00pm	US housing starts; pending home sales. Strive $630M preferred settles
Thu 22 Oct, 8:30pm	US weekly jobless claims; 10:00pm leading index
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly expiry (~14,759 BTC)
Fri 23 Oct, 9:45pm / 10:00pm	US flash PMIs; UMich sentiment
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am	FOMC decision (Fed 27-28 Oct; blackout until 29 Oct)
Thu 29 Oct	ECB decision; US PCE inflation
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry - $12.2B, max pain $79k
Wed 11 Nov	MSCI final list on treasury-company exclusions

5. Summary and prediction

BTC is drifting in an $81k-82k range after a week that ended -1.3%. Hot inflation, a $110 oil price and steady ETF outflows hold it back. Neutral funding and earlier long liquidations mean leverage is not stretched. Options are call-heavy for 30 Oct, but the walls are far above price. Max pain at $79k and thin put support below $80k leave the nearer risk on the downside if Monday's US open turns ugly. Implied volatility is low, so a shock would not be priced in. **24h call: range $80,300-82,800, slight downside tilt; a close under $79,700 is the main warning sign.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base - range	55%	$80,300 - $82,800	Calm US open, flat ETF flows, oil steady
Bullish	20%	$82,800 - $84,500	Hold $81k and reclaim $83k; equities bounce, oil eases, ETF inflows return
Bearish	25%	$78,000 - $80,300	US equity selloff or new Hormuz escalation; break of $79,700 triggers long liquidations

- **Upside signal:** an hourly close above $83,000 with rising volume - next stop $84,300.
- **Downside signal:** a loss of $79,700 (week low) - opens $78,000 and then the mid-$70ks.
- Next report: 7:50am MYT, Monday 19 Oct

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